

A **computer network** is a system where multiple computers and devices are connected together to share information and resources. These devices communicate with each other using communication protocols over wired or wireless connections. Networks allow users to share files, printers, internet connections, and applications easily. For example, in a college computer lab, all computers may be connected to the same network so students can access the internet and shared resources from any system.

Networks are classified into different types based on their size and coverage area. A **Local Area Network (LAN)** connects devices within a small area such as a home, office, or school. A **Metropolitan Area Network (MAN)** covers a larger area like a city, while a **Wide Area Network (WAN)** connects devices over large geographical distances such as countries or continents. The internet is the best example of a WAN because it connects millions of networks around the world.

Computer networks play a very important role in modern communication and technology. They enable services like email, online learning, video conferencing, cloud storage, and social media platforms. Businesses use networks to manage data, communicate with employees, and provide online services to customers. As technology continues to grow, networks are becoming faster, more secure, and more essential for daily life and digital communication.